JAMES HARRISON

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GitHub: github.com/jamesharrison-dev

GITHUB REPOSITORIES

- distributed-cache-engine (TypeScript, Redis, 2.1k stars)

- kubernetes-cost-optimizer (Go, Python, 1.8k stars)

- realtime-analytics-pipeline (Scala, Apache Spark, 956 stars)

- terraform-aws-modules (HCL, Terraform, 742 stars)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a Staff Engineer with over a decade of experience building scalable systems and leading architectural decisions across cloud infrastructure and backend services. Early in my career I moved very quickly through ranks, managing large distributed teams and setting technical direction while still in junior positions. I'm passionate about mentoring other engineers and helping them solve complex problems at scale. Based in London, I enjoy working on problems that require deep systems thinking and have a track record of delivering high-impact solutions under pressure.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer

TechVenture Solutions Ltd

www.techventure-solutions.co

London, United Kingdom

July 2022 - Present

- Architect and oversee microservices infrastructure handling 500k requests per second across 15 services deployed on Kubernetes in AWS

- Mentored a team of 8 junior and mid-level engineers, conducting weekly technical design reviews and establishing coding standards adopted across 80+ person engineering organisation

- Led migration of legacy monolithic application to event-driven architecture using Apache Kafka, reducing latency by 60% and improving system resilience

- Designed and implemented comprehensive observability stack using Prometheus, Grafana, and ELK, reducing mean time to detection for critical issues from 45 minutes to 8 minutes

Graduate Software Developer

CloudCore Industries

cloudcore.io

London, United Kingdom

January 2021 - June 2022

- Managed technical direction and roadmap for entire platform infrastructure team of 24 engineers across three continents, reporting directly to VP of Engineering

- Designed real-time data processing pipeline ingesting 2 terabytes daily using Apache Flink, enabling analytics team to reduce report generation time from 4 hours to 12 minutes

- Established disaster recovery procedures and led company-wide failover testing, achieving 99.99% uptime SLA and saving estimated 2.3 million GBP annually in potential outages

- Drove adoption of infrastructure-as-code practices using Terraform, managing 150+ cloud resources and reducing infrastructure provisioning time from 3 weeks to 45 minutes

Junior Backend Engineer

DataStream Analytics

datastream-analytics.net

London, United Kingdom

March 2019 - December 2020

- Built REST APIs and backend services in Python and Node.js supporting 2 million active users, processing 100+ billion events monthly with 99.95% uptime

- Implemented automated testing framework increasing code coverage from 34% to 87% across codebase of 450k lines of code

- Optimised database queries and implemented intelligent caching strategies, reducing average API response time from 850ms to 120ms and decreasing infrastructure costs by 35%

- Collaborated with product and data teams to define API contracts and data schemas for customer-facing analytics platform

EDUCATION

BSc Computer Science

University of Manchester

Manchester, United Kingdom

Graduated June 2018

Grade: 2:1

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Backend Languages: Python, Go, Scala, Java, Node.js

Cloud Platforms: AWS (EC2, S3, Lambda, RDS, DynamoDB), GCP, Azure

Containerization: Docker, Kubernetes, Helm

Infrastructure as Code: Terraform, CloudFormation, Ansible

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis, DynamoDB, Cassandra

Message Queues: Apache Kafka, RabbitMQ, AWS SQS

Data Processing: Apache Spark, Apache Flink, Beam

Monitoring and Observability: Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack, Datadog, New Relic

CI/CD: Jenkins, GitLab CI, GitHub Actions, CircleCI

Version Control: Git, GitHub, GitLab

System Design: Microservices, distributed systems, event-driven architecture

Protocols: REST, gRPC, WebSockets, GraphQL

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Solutions Architect Professional

Issued August 2021

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA)

Issued March 2022